

Document 15: HIV/AIDS - Transmission and Management

Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV) causes Acquired Immunodeficiency Syndrome (AIDS), a condition in which the immune system becomes severely weakened. HIV is transmitted through blood, sexual contact, sharing of needles, and from mother to child during childbirth or breastfeeding. Early symptoms may resemble flu, but as the disease progresses, individuals become susceptible to opportunistic infections and certain cancers. Antiretroviral therapy (ART) suppresses the virus, prolongs life, and reduces transmission risk. Prevention includes safe sex practices, needle exchange programs, and mother-to-child transmission prevention.